

Amendments: ER/MB2021/3

Project Title	Validation of the MINT questionnaire
Status	Approved
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Applicant Status	UG
Department	Psychology
Project Start Date	23-Jan-2025
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External Funding in place	No
External Collaborators	No
Funder/Project Title	
Name of Funder	

Ethical Review Application ER/MB2021/2 (continued)

Project Description

The present study is a online survey with the aim of validating a new interoceptive questionnaire, by looking at its correlations with other interoceptive scales, traits and disorders. The survey will contain the following parts:

1. Study information and consent form.
2. Standard demographic questions (age, gender, educational level).
3. 12 Questionnaires (MINT; 3 Interoception questionnaires; 4 Trait questionnaires and 4 disorder questionnaires).
4. Physical exercise and wearables questions.
5. Feedback and Debriefing information.

Consent form

At the beginning, participants will be shown information about the study's goal (no deception will be involved).

The page also emphasizes that their response and participation will be kept confidential and entirely anonymous (no IP addresses are collected).

Participant's data is saved only at the end of the study (giving them a chance to retract their participation till the end).

Demographic information

Participant will then answer a few demographic questions designed to better identify the characteristics and representativeness of the sample (age, sex, education level, ethnicity, country of current residence). No IP addresses will be collected, and the deanonymized data with identifiers, will be stored on a University Box only accessible to the researchers.

Questionnaires

Participants will be informed that the study aims to validate a new Interoception questionnaire and that it includes attention-check items. They will be advised that failing these checks may result in withholding their rewards (e.g., credits or payment).

* Interoception questionnaires: MAIA-2 (Mehling et al., 2018); IAS (Murphy et al., 2020) ; BPQ-VSF (Brand et al., 2024)

* Trait questionnaires: TAS20 (Bagby et al., 1994) ; CERQ (Saetren et al., 2025), B-ERS (Veilleux et al., 2024), and PI18 (Clifton, 2019)

* Disorders: PHQ4 (Kroenke et al., 2009) + life satisfaction question; CEFSa-S (Cernis et al., 2024), Mental Health, and Psychosomatic Disorders.

The sequence always begins with the MINT questionnaire, followed by a trait questionnaire-disorder questionnaire or disorder-trait pairing. Subsequent rounds consist of one interoception questionnaire followed by a trait-disorder or disorder-trait pairing. All questionnaires, except the MINT, are randomised within their categories.

Feedback & Debriefing

Participants will be asked if they enjoyed the survey and whether they have any thoughts they want to share. Lastly, a debriefing screen will appear with the aim of the survey explicit (e.g., validation of a new questionnaire) and more information regarding Interoception is given alongside a reminder that data is anonymised.

Participants

Participants will be recruited via convenience sampling (e.g., via social media), or via other recruitment platforms if available (e.g., SONA, Prolific).

The samples from different methods of recruitment will be collected separately in case they are different (the incentive type - e.g., student credits - and amount - or lack thereof - will thus be known to mitigate its potential effect). As we aim at recruiting a diverse sample, there are no exclusion criteria.

Risks

There are no risks involved in this study.

Ethical Review Form Section A (ER/MB2021/2)	
Question	Response
>> Checklist	
A1. Will your study involve participants who are currently or potentially vulnerable or unable to give informed consent or in a dependent position (e.g. people under 18, people with learning difficulties, over-researched groups or people in care facilities)?	No
A2. Will participants be required to take part in the study without their consent or knowledge at the time (e.g. covert observation of people in non-public places), and / or will deception of any sort be used? Please refer to the British Psychological Society Code of Ethics and Conduct (or similar guidelines) for further information.	No
A3. Unless specifically and clearly consented (e.g. a media release form), will it be possible, through a research output, to identify participants in any way? (This does not include taking email details for participant prize draws or identifying participants from signed consent forms or holding identity encryption spreadsheets that are stored securely separate from the research data).	No
A4. Might the study induce psychological stress or anxiety, or produce humiliation or cause harm or negative consequences beyond the risks likely to be encountered in the everyday life of the participants?	No
A5. Is there a risk that the research topic might lead to disclosures from the participant concerning their beliefs, involvement in illegal actions or any other activities that may represent a threat to themselves or others?	No
A6. Will the study involve collecting any personal special category information* in a form that could allow the participant/ participants to be identified? [* identifiers relating to race, ethnic origin, politics, religion, trade union membership, philosophical beliefs, genetics, biometrics, health, sex life or sexual orientation]	Yes
A7. Will any drugs, placebos or other substances (such as food substances or vitamins) be administered as part of this study and will any invasive or potentially harmful procedures of any kind will be used?	No
A8. Will your project involve working with any substances and / or equipment which may be considered hazardous?	No
A9. Will your study involve the taking and/or storage of human tissue that falls under the Human Tissue Act (HTA)? http://www.sussex.ac.uk/staff/research/governance/erp_overview/humantissue	No
>> Risk Assessment	

A10. If you have answered Yes to ANY of the above questions, your application may be considered as HIGH risk. If, however you wish to make a case that your application should be considered as LOW risk please enter the reasons here. Researchers should note that SREOs or C-RECs may decide NOT to agree with the case that you have made.	Participants will be asked to report on their race, gender, age, educational level, ethnicity, and the country of current residence. However, all the data will be anonymised and their participation will be kept confidential (ie., no recording of IP address).
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Ethical Review Form Section B (ER/MB2021/2)	
Question	Response
>> Data Collection and Analysis (Please provide full details)	
B1. PARTICIPANTS: How many people do you envisage will participate, who are they, and how will they be selected?	Study will attempt to recruit a minimum of 300 participants (based on typical samples of similar studies), with no exclusion criteria.
B2. RECRUITMENT: How will participants be approached and recruited?	Participants will be recruited via recruitment platforms (e.g., SONA, Prolific). The samples from different methods of recruitment will be collected separately in case they are different (the incentive type - e.g., student credits - and amount - or lack thereof - will thus be known to mitigate its potential effect).
B3. METHOD: What research method(s) do you plan to use; e.g. interview, questionnaire/self-completion questionnaire, field observation, audio/audio-visual recording?	Online survey.
B4. LOCATION: Where will the project be carried out e.g. public place, in researcher's office, in private office at organisation?	The survey will be completed online.
B5. PARTICIPANT WELLBEING: Will the study involve engaging participants in the discussion of potentially distressing or sensitive topics? (e.g. sexual activity, drug use, ethnicity, political behaviour, potentially illegal activities). If so, please set out how you will manage the well-being of participants.	No.
>> Confidentiality and Anonymity	
B6. Will questionnaires be completed anonymously and returned indirectly?	Yes
B7. Will research data only be identifiable by a unique identifier (e.g. code/pseudonym)? If Yes, please explain how this will be attributed in B11a below.	Yes
B8. Will lists of identity numbers or pseudonyms linked to names and/or addresses be stored securely and separately from the research data? If Yes, explain how this will occur in B11a below.	N/A
B9. Will all place names and institutions which could lead to the identification of individuals or organisations be changed unless this is consented to explicitly in the consent form?	Yes
B10. Will all personal information gathered be treated in strict confidence and never disclosed to any third parties?	Yes
B11. Can you confirm that your research records will be held in accordance with data protection regulations? (http://www.sussex.ac.uk/ogs/policies/information/dpa)	Yes
B11a. Please explain how ANY identifiable personal and/or research data will be managed and securely stored ensuring that participants have given appropriate informed consent for this.	Survey is anonymous so name will not be collected. Deanonymized data is stored privately on university Box.
B12. Do you intend to use the research data for any purpose other than that for which consent is explicitly given? If so, please explain below	No

B12a. If you answered NO to any of the above in this section (or think more information could be useful to the reviewer) please explain here:	Potential for anonymous data sharing is included in the consent.
>> Informed Consent and Recruitment of Participants	
B13. Will all respondents be given an Information Sheet and be given adequate time to read it before being asked to agree to participate?	Yes
B14. Will all participants taking part in an interview, focus group, observation (or other activity which is not questionnaire based) be asked to sign a consent form? If you are obtaining consent another way (such as verbally), please explain under B17 below.	N/A
B15. Will all participants self-completing a questionnaire be asked to show consent to participate by a specific and identifiable action? (Give details in B17 below)	Yes
B16. Will all participants be told that they can withdraw their participation at any time during the research and can ask for their data to be destroyed and/or removed from the project until it is no longer practical to do so?	Yes
B17. If you answered NO to any of the above in this section (or think more information will be useful to the reviewer) please explain here:	Participants will be asked to click a box informing consent for the study.
>> Context	
B18. Is DBS (Disclosure and Barring Service) clearance necessary for this project? If yes, please ensure you complete the next question.	No
B19. Are any other ethical clearances or permissions (internal or external) required? Please see the help text (i) for further details.	No
B19a. If yes, please give further details including the name and address of the organisation. If other ethical approval has already been received please attach evidence of approval, otherwise you will need to supply it when ready. (You do not need to provide evidence of a current DBS check at this point).	
B20. Does the research involve any fieldwork - Overseas or in the UK?	No
B20a. If yes, where will the fieldwork take place? If undertaken overseas you must attach an OTSSRA form. In the event that the Foreign and Commonwealth Office has specific travel warnings in place for the country (ies) to be visited you will also need to provide a detailed risk assessment. https://www.gov.uk/foreign-travel-advice	
B21. Will any researchers be in a lone working situation?	No
B21a. If yes, briefly describe the location, time of day and duration of the lone working. What precautionary measures will be taken to ensure safety of the researcher(s)?	
>> Any further concerns	
B22. Are there any other ethical considerations relating to your project which have not been covered above?	No

B22a. If yes, please explain:	
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